

Story 3	The Code Translator
Story Title	The Code Translator
Meta Goal	To empower non-coders to perform basic data analysis by reframing the AI as a tool that translates natural language questions into executable code.
Target Audience	Professionals and analysts who have data in spreadsheets but lack the coding skills to analyze it programmatically.
Time	9 minutes (Storytelling: 3 min, Live Demo Walkthrough: 6 min)
Context	AI Literacy, Level 3
Version	
Starting Competence	Conscious Incompetence (Knows their data holds answers but feels “stuck in spreadsheet hell,” unable to query it effectively).
Ending Competence	Conscious Competence (Understands the workflow of describing data, asking questions, generating code, and reviewing the output; can perform simple data-to-chart tasks).
Story Objective	Learners see AI as a bridge to a new capability (basic coding for data analysis) and leave with a repeatable workflow for asking questions of their own data.
Essential Question	Is “coding” about writing syntax, or is it about structuring a logical question?
Anchor Question	“What if you could ask your spreadsheet a question in plain English and it gave you back a chart? Let’s try it.”
Story Arc	Setup: We’re good at managing documents (L2), but what about this giant, terrifying CSV file? The answers are in there, but we can’t get them out. Tension: The feeling of being “locked out” of your own data by a lack of coding skill. It’s frustrating and disempowering. Disruption: The AI is introduced not as an analyst, but as a “Code Translator.” Your job isn’t to write code, it’s to describe the data and the goal clearly. The AI handles the syntax. Insight: The hard part isn’t the code, it’s forming a clear, logical question. I can do that! The AI can be my hands, letting me focus on the questions and the results.
Teaching Tools	Slide visuals (“Spreadsheet Hell” vs. “Revealing Chart”), Live demo of the Describe->Ask->Generate->Run workflow with a sample CSV.
Teaching Situation	Full group lecture and live demo, followed by a paired exercise where learners guide each other.

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Tension & Friction	The moment of running the generated code. It might fail. Debugging a simple error (with the AI's help) is a key part of the experience, teaching resilience and the interactive nature of the process. The code itself looks intimidating, but the focus is on the human-readable parts.
Exercise Hook	"You've seen me do it. Now it's your turn. In pairs, one person will be the 'Analyst' who only speaks English, the other is the 'Operator' who puts the code into the machine. Here is a new dataset. Your goal: find the average 'Cost' by 'Destination'."
Teaching Core	Learners experience the direct, empowering loop of translating a human question into a machine-readable answer (a chart). They feel the agency of "interrogating data." By separating the roles in the exercise, they focus on the core skill: forming a good question, not getting bogged down in syntax.
